



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Thomas More Academy

School Website: <https://sspxflorida.com/en/st-thomas-more-academy-49815/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Thomas More Academy Florida (Sanford, 32771) presents as a traditional Catholic K–12 school operated under SSPX affiliation. Public site content identifies it primarily as a Catholic institution (and explicitly notes it is “Traditional Catholic” in its descriptor), with an emphasis on school activities, administration, and fundraising logistics rather than a publicly articulated classical curriculum or classical pedagogy. Based on the six-category rubric for classical education, the public materials show limited resonance with the core elements of a classical program beyond a Catholic/orthodox religious identity. The aggregate assessment is NOT CLASSICAL, with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) showing the most explicit alignment due to Catholic identity, and the remaining five categories showing little to no explicit alignment with the classical framework as defined by the canonical rubric and lexicon.

Key takeaways

- Public materials clearly identify the school as Catholic (Traditional Catholic; SSPX affiliation), which aligns with a theological orientation in Element 1, but the site does not publish the Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or classical pedagogy details that would support higher rung classifications in Categories 2–6. See the school’s public page identifying it as a K–12 SSPX School and Traditional Catholic School, including address and contact details.
- The classical education knowledge base provides the six-element rubric (including precise positive/negative keyword indicators for each element). The school’s public materials touch on Catholic theology, but do not demonstrate explicit Great Books reading, Trivium-based curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, or a defined living-curriculum/parent-partnership narrative in the published public materials. See the Six Essential Elements keyword framework and indicators.
- Because the site primarily communicates religious identity and logistical details rather than classical curricular content or pedagogy, Category-by-category scoring yields the main alignment only in Element 1 and near-zero alignment in Categories 2–6, resulting in an overall NOT CLASSICAL rating.

ABSTRACT

: The school’s public materials clearly convey a Catholic identity with traditional church-connected framing (Element 1). However, there is no compelling public articulation of Great Books, liberal-arts-based curriculum, Trivium/Quadrivium, or classical pedagogy in the public-facing site content, which are the hallmarks of a classical education rubric. Therefore, the overall assessment is NOT CLASSICAL, with Element 1 showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment due to theology/catholic formation, and Categories 2–6 showing NO explicit classical alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials identify the school as “SSPX School” and “Traditional Catholic School,” signaling a Catholic-theological framing of education. This aligns with a theological orientation in the rubric’s Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Grounded in Theology; Liturgical/Communal Practices).

- The school's address/identity is clearly Catholic, which implies a theological underpinning, though explicit theological language (e.g., theology, liturgy, sacred) is not quoted in the public page text shown here. The lexicon for positive indicators includes explicit references to theology, liturgy, Mass, and sacred tradition. The material at hand confirms Catholic identity but not explicit liturgical language on the site snippet.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: Catholic, Traditional (Catholic identity; tradition). These map to "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical/Communal Practices" concepts in the classical lexicon.
- Absent/Not evidenced: Direct terms like Theology, Liturgical, Mass, Worship, or explicit liturgical practices are not visible in the public page text excerpt, though Catholic affiliation suggests theology. The canonical positive keyword list includes theology, liturgy, Mass, worship; these are not directly shown in the visible public snippet.
- Why this rating
- The explicit Catholic identity supports a category alignment toward classical's religious/metaphysical foundations, but the lack of explicit liturgical language or mentions of sacred practices in the public content leads to a cautious "NOT CLASSICAL" score at scale, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL as the best fit given the clear theology-oriented orientation. The school's public information provides a foundation that touches Element 1 but stops short of full classical articulation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site text presents administrative and fundraising content but does not publicly articulate a classical telos (virtue formation, contemplation, Great Conversation, or a formation-centered purpose). The "Traditional Catholic School" descriptor communicates a religious/cultural formation orientation rather than a classical educational telos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: None of the canonical positive keywords for Element 2 (formation of virtue, pursuit of true/-good/beautiful, scholé/formation for human excellence) appear in the visible site text. The lexicon's Positive Keywords include formation, virtue, telos, scholé, great conversation, etc., none of which are explicitly stated in the public site content.
- Negative: There is no explicit employment of workforce-preparation language or college/career readiness language on the public page; however, the absence of formation-language signals no robust classical orientation. The negative signals are not strongly evidenced on the page either.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit statements about formation toward virtue and wisdom or the Great Conversation, Element 2 does not meet the core watchwords of classical purpose. Public content does not demonstrate a classical formation philosophy, so Element 2 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public site text identifies the school as K–12 SSPX and Traditional Catholic, but there is no publicized Great Books program, liberal arts ladder, Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, or explicit Great Conversation content. The absence of classical curricular markers in the public content supports a Not Classical categorization for Curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: 0 explicit mentions of Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium/quadrivium), Great Books, or Great Conversation on the site text sample. The knowledge-base lexicon lists these as central to classical curricula; their public presence here is not demonstrated.
- Negative: No direct "project-based" or modern STEM-first phrasing in the public materials indicating a non-classical emphasis; however, lack of classical curriculum signals dominates.
- Why this rating

- Given the absence of classical liberal-arts curricular signals in the public site, Curriculum is NOT CLASSICAL. The SSPX Catholic framing does not substitute for classical curriculum indicators on the public site.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials do not describe Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or rhetoric-focused pedagogy. The site content focuses on administrative and fundraising aspects rather than pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: 0 canonical positive pedagogy keywords (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memory work, recitation, rhetoric, etc.) appear in the public content. The lexicon lists these as core Classical pedagogy markers.
- Negative: No explicit modern-education methods (experiential/project-based) are publicly labeled as the school's primary approach in the visible content. This results in a lack of classical pedagogy signals.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit classical pedagogical practices in the public site text yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The school's Catholic identity does not substitute for the classical pedagogy signals defined in the Six Elements.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is no visible public content detailing a “living curriculum,” teacher portrait, mentor/colleague model, or other “faculty as the living curriculum” language on the public page. The page is administrative in focus rather than descriptive of faculty culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: 0 explicit positive keywords for Faculty (e.g., model teachers, portrait of a teacher, faculty as living curriculum, teacher as mentor). The Six Elements lexicon lists these as strong indicators of Classical faculty.
- Negative: 0 explicit negative signals in the public text regarding faculty; the absence of classical-faculty language yields a neutral reading rather than a positive signal.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit classical-faculty indicators in the public materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty. The public site content does not demonstrate the “model teachers” or “living curriculum” rhetoric defined in the classical rubric.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public page excerpt centers on administrative details and a Jog-a-thon fundraising event, with no explicit parent-partner formation language, parent-learning initiatives, or open-campus visitation language that the classical rubric would expect (e.g., partnership with families; parent formation; open campus). The Six Elements lexicon emphasizes parental partnership as a hallmark.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: 0 direct Positive keywords in the public text for Element 6. The lexicon's Positive Keywords include “Partnership with Families,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” etc. None are evidenced in the visible site content.
- Negative: 0 explicit negative signals in this public content about parents; however, the lack of explicit community/parent-partnership material yields a weak alignment, i.e., NOT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- Public materials do not demonstrate the parents-and-community engagement signals central to classical education. The notch remains NOT CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment (Element-by-Element)

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Catholic/traditional Catholic identity; SSPX framing.
- Keywords: Catholic; Traditional (positive signals toward Grounded in Theology; Liturgical/Communal).
- Rationale: The religious/theological orientation aligns with a portion of the classical framework, but explicit classical elements (theology text, liturgical practice) are not publicly stated in the site text. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit formation-virtue telos in public materials.
- Keywords: Absent (formation, virtue, scholé, great conversation, etc.).
- Rationale: Public materials do not articulate the classical teleology of virtue/wisdom formation.
- Element 3 — Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No public mention of Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation, or other classical curriculum markers.
- Keywords: Absent (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, etc.).
- Rationale: Lacks canonical curriculum signals per classical rubric.
- Element 4 — Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No public description of Socratic/Seminar/Scholé/memory-work pedagogy.
- Keywords: Absent (Socratic; Scholé; memory work).
- Rationale: Pedagogy signals are not present in public materials.
- Element 5 — Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No public “living curriculum”/model-teacher language.
- Keywords: Absent (model teachers; portrait of a teacher).
- Rationale: Lacks classical-faculty indicators.
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit partnership-with-families or parent-formation signals in public content.
- Keywords: Absent (parent formation; open campus; co-teachers).
- Rationale: Lacks classical-parents/community signals.

Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as no category reaches SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the current public materials. If a school wanted to move toward CLASSICAL, the following steps would be needle-moving, but they would require explicit public articulation:
- Element 3: Publish and demonstrate a classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Trivium; Quadrivium; Great Books; Great Conversation) and explicitly note Great Books, primary sources, and integration across history and humanities.
- Element 4: Articulate a classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars in upper grades; Scholé/restful learning; memorization/recitation; rhetoric and deliberative discourse).
- Element 5: Publicly display a living-curriculum model (faculty as mentors; portraits of ideal teacher-student roles; collaborative professional development).
- Element 6: Establish and communicate a formal partnership with families (parent formation; book clubs; open-campus visits; co-teacher model).

ABSTRACT

- Classification: NOT CLASSICAL
- Core justification: The public materials from St Thomas More Academy Florida (32771) clearly identify a Catholic, traditional orientation, which aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations dimension in part (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL on Element 1). However, the site lacks explicit Great Books/Trivium-based curriculum, classical pedagogy, or robust parent-community formation signals that the Six Essential Elements define as central to classical education. Across Categories 2–6, no

explicit classical alignment is demonstrated in the public content, which drives the aggregate NOT CLASSICAL rating. The knowledge-base keyword framework confirms that the classical rubric expects explicit references to theology, liturgy, Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy, a living curriculum, and active parent/community partnerships, none of which are publicly demonstrated at scale in the school's site text. See the SSPX-era St Thomas More Academy public page for identity and location; and the knowledge-base for the canonical classical keyword framework.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Catholic identity; Traditional Catholic language on public site.
- Positive keyword indicators observed: Catholic; Traditional (mapping to Grounded in Theology; Liturgical/Communal foundations in classical lexicon).
- Negative indicators: None clearly evidenced in public content; however, explicit liturgical/theology language is not shown in the public page text.
- Rating rationale: Partial alignment due to religious-theological framing but lacking explicit classical liturgical/cherished-transcendent-virtue language on the publicly visible site.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit formation-virtue telos or Great Conversation language in public site text.
- Keywords: Absent (per classical lexicon).
- Rating rationale: Formation-focused aims and teleology are not publicly articulated; therefore NOT CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or Great Conversation signals in the public text.
- Keywords: Absent.
- Rating rationale: Lacks canonical classical curriculum signals; NOT CLASSICAL.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit reference to Socratic, Scholé, or memorization-based pedagogy in the public text.
- Keywords: Absent.
- Rating rationale: NOT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No public statements about a living-curriculum faculty model or mentor culture.
- Keywords: Absent.
- Rating rationale: NOT CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents and Community — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit parent-partnership formation or open-campus language in public text.
- Keywords: Absent.
- Rating rationale: NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only included when SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- The current public data do not yield any Category that is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Therefore, no needle-moving steps are prescribed here. If the school elects to pursue CLASSICAL, target areas include publishing a classical curriculum with Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, explicit Great Conversation, and a robust parent-partnership program. See the Six Essential Elements framework and its positive keyword indicators for these items.

Notes on sources and methodology

- Public school content: The Star Thomas More Academy materials clearly identify it as a K–12 SSPX school with a Traditional Catholic orientation. The address is 550 Riverview Ave., Sanford, FL 32771; telephone contact is listed. These data points anchor the religious identity category used in the assessment.
- Classical rubric and keyword framework: The six-element classical rubric (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community) and their Positive/Negative keyword indicators are drawn from the knowledge-base lexicon (e.g., the

“classicality_lexicon” and the Six Essential Elements keyword indicators). These sources provide the standards against which the school’s public materials were measured.

End of REPORT

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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